Ford Motor Company

Service Recall Bulletin

August 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: **DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD - Safety Recall 00S19-S1:** Certain 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles – Steering Wheel Retention Nut and Steering Column Replacement

REASON FOR SUPPLEMENTAL INFORMATION – ADDITIONAL UNITS ADDED; BUILD DATE RANGE EXPANDED

An additional 143 units have been identified as being affected by Safety Recall 00S19 and the build date range has been expanded to include vehicles built from January 31, 2000. Note change to affected vehicles in the following section, AFFECTED VEHICLES.

The Technical Instructions have been updated to reflect a revised procedure for disconnecting the speed control / horn electrical connection. Refer to Attachment III 00S19-S1.

AFFECTED VEHICLES

All 2001 model year Escape vehicles built at the Kansas City Assembly plant from **January 31, 2000 through July 26, 2000**.

SAFETY CONCERN

Affected vehicles are equipped with a steering wheel armature that contains a retention nut that may 1) be installed upside down and 2) have improper hardness characteristics. A steering wheel retention nut installed upside down may cause a fracture of the steering column shaft. A steering wheel retention nut with improper hardness characteristics may crack or fracture during the assembly process.

Either condition may allow the steering wheel to separate from the steering column shaft. If steering control is lost, it could potentially lead to a vehicle crash.

SERVICE ACTION

Dealers are to inspect and replace the steering wheel retention armature and, if necessary, the steering column to correct this condition.

Do not drive, demonstrate, deliver or perform pre-delivery inspection on any vehicles affected by this recall until this repair has been performed.

Dealers should be aware that special handling of the customer's vehicle is requested, and dealers will be reimbursed to wash, vacuum and re-fill the vehicle with fuel after the service is complete.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information, Updated – Version 00S19-S1
Attachment IV: Escape Owner Special Handling Instructions
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information: 1-800-423-8851
Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions: 1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD - Safety Recall 00S19-S1:
All 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles – Steering Wheel Retention Nut and Steering Column Replacement

OASIS

OASIS will be activated for this Safety recall. You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

RENTAL CARS

Ford Motor Company will pay for a rental vehicle, except for fuel, which will be at the owner's expense. Enter the word "RENTAL" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the Miscellaneous Expense area. Reference the Escape Owner Special Handling Instructions (Attachment IV) for further information.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD - Safety Recall 00S19-S1:
All 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles – Steering Wheel Retention Nut and Steering Column Replacement

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Inspection and Replace Steering Wheel Retention Armature	00S19B	0.9 Hours
Inspection and Replace Steering Wheel Retention Armature and Steering Column	00S19C	1.9 Hours
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hours

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Parts will not be direct shipped for this recall. Order your parts requirement through the Recall Hotline (1-800-325-5621). Parts will be shipped Priority Next Day delivery.

Part Number	Description	Quantity
YL8Z-3612-AA	Armature, Steering Wheel	1

NOTE: Removed parts must be mutilated and properly scrapped to prevent their use on another vehicle.

ORDER INFORMATION DOR/COR

DOR/COR number 50173 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline (1-800-325-5621).

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

EXCESS STOCK RETURN

Excess stock returned for credit must have been purchased from Ford Customer Service Division in accordance with Policy Procedure Bulletin 4000.

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD - Safety Recall 00S19-S1:
All 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles – Steering Wheel Retention Nut and Steering Column Replacement

If Dealer Picks up and Returns Vehicle for Customer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
• Pick up the customer's vehicle (from a location of their preference such as home or place of business) • Drop off comparable loaner vehicle • Refill fuel tank • Wash and vacuum vehicle • Return vehicle to customer after repair is completed	• Actual time, up to 1.0 hours, for vehicle pick up/return, to fill tank, wash and vacuum • Actual cost of fuel, wash and vacuum • Labor subject to time recording procedures as outlined in Warranty & Policy Manual	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash+vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP" EXAMPLE (using example labor rate of $62.36/hour and fuel cost of $1.50/gallon): 1.0 hrs. labor* = $ 62.36 9.0 gals fuel = $ 13.50 Wash/vacuum = $ 10.00 Total Submitted = $ 85.86 * Travel and labor time to pick up/return vehicle, to fuel, wash and vacuum the vehicle
Provide comparable rental vehicle to customer when vehicle is picked up	Actual cost up to a maximum of $28 per day for a Ford rental (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 1 day maximum using "RENTAL"
Perform repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified	See applicable information

DEMONSTRATION / DELIVERY HOLD - Safety Recall 00S19-S1:
All 2001 Model Year Escape Vehicles – Steering Wheel Retention Nut and Steering Column Replacement

If Customer Brings Vehicle to Dealer:

Special Service	Dealer Compensation	Claim Procedure
Refill fuel tank and wash/ vacuum vehicle	• Actual time, up to 0.5 hour, to fill tank, wash and vacuum • Actual cost of fuel, wash and vacuum • Labor subject to time recording procedures as outlined in Warranty & Policy Manual	Submit total dollar value (labor+fuel+wash+vacuum) using Misc. Expense Code "LCHP" EXAMPLE (using example labor rate of $62.36/hour and fuel cost of $1.50/gallon): 0.3 hrs. labor* = $ 18.71 9.0 gals fuel = $ 13.50 Wash/vacuum = $ 10.00 Total Submitted = $ 42.21 * Travel and labor time to fuel, wash and vacuum the vehicle when the vehicle is brought to dealer by the customer
Provide comparable rental vehicle to customer when vehicle is dropped off at the dealership	Actual cost up to a maximum of $28 per day for a Ford rental (This does not count against TAP allocation)	Submit up to 1 day maximum using "RENTAL"
Perform repair at dealership	Inspection/repair labor allowance as specified	See applicable information

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-392-3673
www.ownerconnection.com

August 2000

00S19

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is being sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect that relates to motor vehicle safety exists in all 2001 model year Escape vehicles built January 31, 2000 through July 26, 2000.

We apologize for this situation and want to assure you that with your assistance we will correct this condition. Our commitment, together with Ford dealers, is to provide you with the highest level of service and support possible.

What the safety issue is…

Affected vehicles are equipped with a steering wheel armature that contains a retention nut that may 1) be installed upside down and 2) have improper hardness characteristics. A steering wheel retention nut installed upside down may cause a fracture of the steering column shaft. A steering wheel retention nut with improper hardness characteristics may crack or fracture during the assembly process.

Either condition may allow the steering wheel to separate from the steering column shaft. If steering control is lost, it could potentially lead to a vehicle crash.

What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do...

Your dealer is to inspect and replace the steering wheel retention armature and, if necessary, the steering column to correct this condition. Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for this service.

How long will it take?

The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do…

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date and whether parts are in stock for Safety Recall 00S19.

If your dealer does not have the parts in stock, they can be ordered before scheduling your service date. Parts would be expected to arrive within a week after ordering.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle…

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns…

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Assistance Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8:00 am - 11:00 pm
Saturday: 9:00 am - 6:00 pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 (Washington, D. C. area residents may call 1-202-366-0123).

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.



Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,

Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs